



Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

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LESSON PLAN

For



WSQ CompTIA Certified Cloud+ Training

TGS Ref No: TGS-2024049214

Conducted by

Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

UEN: 201200696W

Version 2.1

DOCUMENT VERSION CONTROL RECORD

Version Number	Effective Date of Release	Summary of Included Changes	Author
1.0	1 Jul 2026	First release. 36 hands-on labs mapped to CV0-004 domains 1–6.	Dr. Alfred Ang
2.0	19 Aug 2026	Major revision. Deck expanded with full per-domain teaching content covering every CV0-004 exam sub-objective (31 blueprint topics, 500+ visual slides); labs restructured into one folder per lab; free web-tool kit (IP Calculator, PCAP Analyzer, Regex Generator, Cybersecurity Simulator) integrated into the labs.	Dr. Alfred Ang
2.1	19 Aug 2026	Lab platforms split by workload: Kubernetes labs move to the Killercoda Kubernetes playground, container labs may run on Docker Desktop, Linux labs stay on the Ubuntu playground. Each lab, slide and Learner Guide section now names its platform. Labs ship 41 ready-made asset files (Dockerfiles, Compose files, Kubernetes manifests, Terraform, Ansible playbooks, configs and scripts) so learners can download instead of retyping.	Dr. Alfred Ang

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Course Overview

The **WSQ CompTIA Certified Cloud+ Training** (CV0-004) is a 2-day, hands-on WSQ course that prepares learners for the CompTIA Cloud+ CV0-004 certification. It maps 36 practical labs to the six exam domains, delivered on free browser-based lab platforms.

- **TGS Ref No:** TGS-2024049214
- **TSC:** Cloud Computing (ICT-DIT-5020-1.1)
- **Duration:** 2 days (9:30 AM – 6:30 PM each day, 8 instructional hours)
- **Delivery:** Instructor-led lecture + hands-on labs. Each lab names its platform:
- Killercode Ubuntu Playground — the Linux labs — <https://killercode.com/playgrounds/scenario/ubuntu>
- Killercode Kubernetes Playground — the Kubernetes labs (Lab 32) — <https://killercode.com/playgrounds/scenario/kubernetes>
- Docker Desktop — optional, for the container labs (Labs 6, 12, 36) — <https://www.docker.com/products/docker-desktop/>

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this course, participants will be able to:

- Explain cloud architecture, service models (IaaS/PaaS/SaaS/FaaS) and the shared responsibility model, and design highly-available, well-networked cloud solutions.
- Deploy cloud workloads using containers, virtualization, Infrastructure as Code and modern release strategies (blue-green, canary, rolling).
- Operate cloud systems with observability, logging, tracing, auto-scaling, backup/recovery and lifecycle management.
- Secure a cloud environment with vulnerability management, hardening, IAM/RBAC, secrets management, WAF and runtime threat detection.
- Apply DevOps fundamentals — source control, CI/CD, APIs and container orchestration.
- Troubleshoot common cloud deployment, network, security and container issues methodically.

Exam Domain Coverage

Domain	Exam Weight	Labs
1. Cloud Architecture	23%	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8
2. Deployment	19%	9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15
3. Operations	17%	16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21
4. Security	19%	22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28
5. DevOps Fundamentals	10%	29, 30, 31, 32
6. Troubleshooting	12%	33, 34, 35, 36

Daily Schedule

Each training day runs **9:30 AM – 6:30 PM** and totals **exactly 8 instructional hours (480 minutes)**. The 1-hour lunch is excluded from instructional time; the two short tea breaks are comfort breaks counted **within** the instructional day, per the WSQ house schedule.

The **Slides** column maps each session to the matching pages in the course slide deck (*CompTIA Cloud+ (CV0-004) Slides v2.1*, 562 slides).

Day 1 — Cloud Architecture, Deployment & Operations

Time	Duration	Topic / Activity	Method	Slides
9:30–10:00	30 min	Registration, AM Digital Attendance, trainer & learner introductions, Ground Rules, Course Outline, Learning Outcomes	Admin	—
10:00–11:15	1 hr 15 min	Domain 1 — Cloud Architecture: cloud concepts, service models & shared responsibility, high availability, VPC networking (Labs 1–3)	Lecture + Hands-on labs	Slides 136–138
11:15–11:25	10 min	Morning break	Break	—
11:25–12:30	1 hr 5 min	Domain 1 continued: storage tiers, microservices, containerization (Labs 4–6)	Hands-on labs	Slides 139–141
12:30–1:30	1 hr	Lunch break	Break	—
1:30–2:30	1 hr	Domain 1 continued: virtualization, relational vs non-relational databases (Labs 7–8)	Hands-on labs	Slides 142–143
2:30–4:00	1 hr 30 min	Domain 2 — Deployment: public/private/hybrid models, blue-green, canary and rolling deployments (Labs 9–12)	Lecture + Hands-on labs	Slides 227–230
4:00–4:10	10 min	Afternoon break	Break	—
4:10–5:30	1 hr 20 min	Domain 2 continued: Infrastructure as Code (Terraform),	Hands-on labs	Slides 231–233

		Configuration as Code (Ansible), JSON & YAML scripting logic (Labs 13–15)		
5:30–6:30	1 hr	Domain 3 — Operations: observability with Prometheus & Grafana, centralized logging (ELK), distributed tracing (Jaeger) (Labs 16–18)	Lecture + Hands-on labs	Slides 305–307

Day 2 — Security, DevOps, Troubleshooting & Assessment

Time	Duration	Topic / Activity	Method	Slides
9:30–9:45	15 min	AM Digital Attendance, recap of Day 1	Admin	—
9:45–11:15	1 hr 30 min	Domain 3 continued: horizontal auto-scaling, backup & recovery (restic), patching & lifecycle management (Labs 19–21)	Hands-on labs	Slides 308–310
11:15–11:25	10 min	Morning break	Break	—
11:25–12:30	1 hr 5 min	Domain 4 — Security: vulnerability scanning (Trivy), CIS hardening (Lynis), IAM & RBAC (Keycloak) (Labs 22–24)	Lecture + Hands-on labs	Slides 402–404
12:30–1:30	1 hr	Lunch break	Break	—
1:30–2:45	1 hr 15 min	Domain 4 continued: bastion + MFA, secrets management (Vault), WAF (ModSecurity + OWASP CRS), runtime detection (Falco) (Labs 25–28)	Hands-on labs	Slides 405–408
2:45–3:45	1 hr	Domain 5 — DevOps Fundamentals: Git source control & branching, CI/CD pipelines, REST/GraphQL APIs, Kubernetes with k3s (Labs 29–	Lecture + Hands-on labs	Slides 477–480

		32)		
3:45–3:55	10 min	Afternoon break	Break	—
3:55–4:30	35 min	Domain 6 — Troubleshooting: deployment, network, security and container/resource triage (Labs 33–36); Briefing for Assessment	Hands-on + Briefing	Slides 550–553
4:30–6:30	2 hr	Assessment: Written Assessment (1 hr) + Practical Performance (1 hr). TRAQOM survey and answer submission on the LMS.	Assessment	—

Topic-by-Topic Breakdown

Domain 1 — Cloud Architecture (23%) — Deck: divider slide 20; Slides 136–143

Cloud concepts, service and deployment models, the shared responsibility model, high availability, networking (VPC), storage tiers, virtualization, databases and cloud-native / microservices design.

Lab 1 — Cloud Service Models & Shared Responsibility · Slide 136

Goal: Run a local stand-in for each cloud service model and articulate who is responsible for what under the shared responsibility model.

Key concepts:

- The four service models — IaaS, PaaS, SaaS, FaaS — and what each abstracts away
- Shared responsibility: who owns data, app, runtime, OS and hardware at each layer
- FaaS traits: event-driven, scales to zero, billed per invocation
- Mapping real services (EC2, managed Postgres, M365, Lambda) to each model

Tools: Docker, curl, jq, nginx, postgres:16, nextcloud

Lab 2 — High Availability with HAProxy & Keepalived · Slide 137

Goal: Build a health-checked load balancer across two AZ backends and add VRRP failover so a virtual IP survives a load-balancer failure.

Key concepts:

- Multi-AZ load balancing and round-robin distribution across backends

- Active health checks that auto-remove unhealthy instances
- Keepalived / VRRP floating virtual IP (VIP) for LB redundancy
- Active-passive HA: the BACKUP node takes the VIP when the MASTER dies

Tools: HAProxy, Keepalived, Docker, nginx:alpine, curl

Lab 3 — Cloud Networking with VPC Namespaces · Slide 138

Goal: Construct a full VPC — two subnets, a router, a security-group rule and a NAT gateway — entirely from Linux network namespaces.

Key concepts:

- A VPC/subnet is a kernel network feature (network namespace = subnet)
- Route tables, default routes and IP forwarding for inter-subnet routing
- Security groups operate per-flow at L3/L4 (iptables = AWS SG / Azure NSG)
- NAT gateway (MASQUERADE) lets private subnets reach the internet

Tools: iproute2 (ip netns), iptables, sysctl, ping

Lab 4 — Storage Tiers (Block, Object, File) · Slide 139

Goal: Create one block, one object and one file store locally, then benchmark IOPS to explain why storage tiers (and their prices) differ.

Key concepts:

- Three storage types: block (EBS), object (S3), file (EFS/Azure Files)
- Object storage is key-addressed over HTTP with no filesystem; file is POSIX/NFS
- Measuring random-write IOPS with fio to compare tier performance
- Hot / warm / cold / archive tiering and how cost follows performance

Tools: fio, losetup/mkfs.ext4, MinIO + mc, NFS, Docker

Lab 5 — Microservices & Service Discovery · Slide 140

Goal: Deploy three loosely-coupled microservices behind Consul and demonstrate name-based service discovery, fan-out and resilience under a single failure.

Key concepts:

- Services register / deregister with a service registry (Consul)
- Clients resolve services by name (users.service.consul), not IP
- Fan-out pattern: one request triggers parallel calls to many services
- Loose coupling: killing one service leaves the others running

Tools: HashiCorp Consul, Docker bridge network, curl, jq, dig

Lab 6 — Containerization with Docker · Slide 141

Goal: Practise every core containerization sub-objective — build/run/expose, ephemeral vs persistent storage, public/private registries and a Compose preview.

Key concepts:

- Image lifecycle: build, tag, run, push (Dockerfile FROM/COPY/EXPOSE)
- Port mapping (-p host:container)
- Ephemeral storage vs persistent volumes
- Public vs private image registries (Docker Hub vs a local registry:2)

Tools: Docker, Dockerfile, registry:2, Docker Compose

Lab 7 — Virtualization with QEMU/KVM · Slide 142

Goal: Create and clone a QEMU VM to understand core virtualization concepts and contrast VMs with containers.

Key concepts:

- Hypervisor virtualization vs containerization (own kernel vs shared kernel)
- qcow2 copy-on-write disks and linked clones (basis of snapshots/templates)
- Hardware-assisted virtualization (Intel vmx / AMD svm)
- VM network types (user-mode NAT vs bridged) and host affinity / CPU pinning

Tools: QEMU, qemu-img, libvirt, bridge-utils, Alpine ISO

Lab 8 — Relational vs Non-Relational Databases · Slide 143

Goal: Run and compare a self-managed relational DB against a document DB to learn when to choose each and how managed services shift responsibility.

Key concepts:

- Relational model: strict schema, ACID, foreign keys, JOINS (Postgres)
- Document model: schemaless, nested documents, built-in sharding (MongoDB)
- Self-managed vs provider-managed responsibility split
- Workload-to-engine selection and provider-managed equivalents (RDS, Cosmos...)

Tools: Docker, PostgreSQL 16 + psql, MongoDB + mongosh

Domain 2 — Deployment (19%) — Deck: divider slide 144; Slides 227–233

Provisioning and configuring cloud resources: deployment models, zero-downtime release strategies (blue-green, canary, rolling), Infrastructure as Code, Configuration as Code and scripting logic.

Lab 9 — Public, Private & Hybrid Cloud Models · Slide 227

Goal: Simulate public (LocalStack), private (MinIO) and hybrid deployment models to compare their cost, control and elasticity trade-offs.

Key concepts:

- Public (multi-tenant, pay-per-use) vs private (single-tenant, high CapEx)

- Hybrid: the same S3 API spans both clouds and enables cloud bursting
- Community cloud is a policy/access concept, not new infrastructure
- A consistent API (S3) can span deployment models

Tools: LocalStack, MinIO + mc, AWS CLI, WireGuard, Docker

Lab 10 — Blue-Green Deployment with Nginx · Slide 228

Goal: Run blue (v1) and green (v2) side by side and switch live traffic instantly via an Nginx reload to achieve zero-downtime deployment.

Key concepts:

- Blue-green keeps two parallel environments; cutover is a config change
- Atomic traffic cutover via 'nginx -s reload' with no dropped connections
- Smoke-test the new version out of band before flipping traffic
- Instant, symmetrical rollback; trade-off is 2× resources

Tools: Nginx, Docker (nginx:alpine), curl

Lab 11 — Canary Deployment with HAProxy · Slide 229

Goal: Gradually shift live traffic from v1 to v2 using HAProxy server weights to safely validate a new release before full promotion.

Key concepts:

- Canary = a small percentage of real traffic on the new version first
- Weight-based routing (90/10 → 50/50 → 100%) = ALB weighted target groups / Istio
- Gradual promotion and instant weight-reset rollback
- Always pair canary with metrics and alerts

Tools: HAProxy, Docker (nginx:alpine), curl

Lab 12 — Rolling Deployment with Docker Compose · Slide 230

Goal: Deploy three load-balanced replicas and upgrade them one at a time to perform a zero-downtime rolling update.

Key concepts:

- Rolling = replace replicas one (or a batch) at a time while others serve
- Produces a brief mixed-version window; cheaper than blue-green
- Load balancing across replicas via HAProxy server-template + resolvers
- Always pair with a readiness check before progressing

Tools: Docker Compose, HAProxy, curl

Lab 13 — Infrastructure as Code with Terraform · Slide 231

Goal: Write a Terraform config that provisions an S3 bucket on LocalStack and experience plan/apply, state, drift detection and versioning.

Key concepts:

- IaC: declarative configuration becomes real cloud resources
- The plan-before-apply workflow
- Drift detection compares real vs desired state
- State (terraform.tfstate) is the source of truth and must be stored safely

Tools: Terraform, LocalStack, awslocal, Git, Docker

Lab 14 — Configuration as Code with Ansible · Slide 232

Goal: Write an Ansible playbook that installs and configures Nginx idempotently and prove drift correction.

Key concepts:

- Configuration as Code: YAML playbooks declare desired state
- Idempotency — tasks only act when current state differs (changed vs ok)
- Re-running restores desired state after manual tampering
- Variables, conditionals (when:) and roles compose larger configs

Tools: Ansible, ansible-galaxy, YAML, curl

Lab 15 — JSON & YAML Scripting Logic · Slide 233

Goal: Parse, transform, validate and convert JSON ↔ YAML while exercising the exam's scripting-logic primitives.

Key concepts:

- Read, write, validate and convert JSON and YAML (same data, two formats)
- Shared data types: string, number, boolean, array, object
- Scripting-logic primitives: variables, conditionals, operators, functions (jq)
- Validate at the boundary — fail early on malformed input

Tools: jq, yq, diff, web validators

Domain 3 — Operations (17%) — Deck: divider slide 234; Slides 305–310

Running cloud systems day-to-day: observability (metrics, logs, traces), alerting, auto-scaling, backup & disaster recovery, and patching / lifecycle management.

Lab 16 — Observability with Prometheus & Grafana · Slide 305

Goal: Scrape a node's metrics with Prometheus, visualise them in Grafana and trigger a CPU alert.

Key concepts:

- Metrics pillar: Prometheus scrapes a source (node-exporter) on an interval
- Grafana visualises Prometheus as a data source

- Threshold alerting: a PromQL rule fires when a condition holds for a duration
- The operational loop: alerting → triage → response

Tools: Prometheus, Grafana, node-exporter, stress-ng, Docker

Lab 17 — Centralized Logging with the ELK Stack · Slide 306

Goal: Run ELK, ship logs into it, and query and retain them through the Elasticsearch API.

Key concepts:

- The centralized logging pipeline: collect → ship → store → query
- Elasticsearch (store/index), Logstash (ingest/transform), Kibana (query/visualise)
- Retention enforced with ILM (Index Lifecycle Management) policies
- ELK and OpenSearch share the same query DSL

Tools: Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana, Docker, curl, jq

Lab 18 — Distributed Tracing with Jaeger · Slide 307

Goal: Run Jaeger, instrument a Python 'checkout' path with OpenTelemetry and view a distributed trace of parent/child spans.

Key concepts:

- Tracing is the third pillar of observability (metrics/logs/traces)
- Spans are the unit; a trace is a set of causally-linked spans across services
- OpenTelemetry is the vendor-neutral instrumentation API (OTLP export)
- A trace reveals the critical path — the slowest span — of one request

Tools: Jaeger, OpenTelemetry Python SDK, Docker, python3, curl

Lab 19 — Horizontal Auto-Scaling Simulation · Slide 308

Goal: Simulate triggered, scheduled and manual horizontal scaling using a Bash controller that watches CPU and adds/removes Docker replicas.

Key concepts:

- Three scaling trigger families: triggered/load-based, scheduled, manual
- An auto-scaler is a control loop that watches a metric and adjusts replicas
- Horizontal scaling (add replicas) vs vertical scaling (resize one instance)
- Horizontal scaling is the cloud-native default (AWS ASG, K8s HPA)

Tools: Docker Compose, stress-ng, cron, nginx:alpine

Lab 20 — Backup & Recovery with restic · Slide 309

Goal: Perform encrypted full/incremental/differential backups to off-site S3 storage, then test recoverability and verify integrity.

Key concepts:

- Full vs incremental vs differential backup semantics and restore trade-offs
- Encrypted, deduplicating backups to off-site S3-compatible storage
- Recoverability testing (granular and bulk restore) is mandatory
- Integrity verification and retention policies (keep-daily/weekly + prune)

Tools: restic, MinIO, Docker

Lab 21 — Patching & Lifecycle Management · Slide 310

Goal: Simulate a cloud resource lifecycle from provision through minor patch, major upgrade, testing and clean decommissioning.

Key concepts:

- The full lifecycle: provision → configure → monitor → patch → scale → backup → decommission
- Minor patches (no behaviour change) vs major upgrades (breaking) risk profiles
- Persistent data must survive upgrades; ephemeral state may vanish
- EoL/EoS items must be replaced, not patched; decommission = archive + revoke + delete

Tools: apt, unattended-upgrades, Docker, curl

Domain 4 — Security (19%) — Deck: divider slide 311; Slides 402–408

Securing the cloud: vulnerability management, CIS hardening, IAM & RBAC, secure access (bastion + MFA), secrets management, web application firewalls and runtime threat detection.

Lab 22 — Vulnerability Scanning with Trivy · Slide 402

Goal: Scan a container image, filesystem and IaC config with Trivy following the scope → identify → assess → remediate workflow.

Key concepts:

- The four-step vulnerability-management workflow: scope → identify → assess → remediate
- CVE (identifier) + CVSS (severity) as the universal vulnerability vocabulary
- Three scan surfaces: container image, filesystem (secrets), IaC config
- The CI 'gate' — a non-zero exit code fails the build

Tools: Trivy, Docker, sample Terraform

Lab 23 — CIS Benchmark Audit with Lynis · Slide 403

Goal: Audit the VM against the CIS Ubuntu Benchmark with Lynis, score it, remediate findings and re-audit to confirm improvement.

Key concepts:

- Benchmarks (CIS) are objective, measurable targets; hardening closes the gap
- The Lynis hardening index is a quantifiable score
- Findings map to specific CIS controls (file permissions, kernel modules)
- Different benchmarks per layer: OS, Docker Bench, kube-bench, Prowler

Tools: Lynis, chmod, sysctl, Docker Bench Security

Lab 24 — IAM & RBAC with Keycloak · Slide 404

Goal: Stand up Keycloak and build a full IAM stack — realm, roles, users, an OAuth2 client — then authenticate and inspect RBAC roles in the JWT.

Key concepts:

- IAM building blocks: identity provider, realms (tenants), users, roles, clients
- OAuth 2.0 + OIDC token flow (bearer JWT access token)
- RBAC — roles propagate via JWT realm_access.roles claims
- Authentication models: local, federation/SAML, OIDC, LDAP, MFA

Tools: Keycloak, Docker, curl, jq

Lab 25 — Bastion Host with SSH Key + MFA · Slide 405

Goal: Configure key-based SSH with TOTP MFA and route access through a locked-down bastion jump host — the canonical secure cloud-VM access pattern.

Key concepts:

- SSH public-key authentication replacing passwords
- TOTP multi-factor auth chained via AuthenticationMethods / PAM
- Bastion / jump-host pattern (internet → bastion → private subnet)
- Restricting bastion access to corporate CIDRs; audit trails for compliance

Tools: OpenSSH, ssh-keygen, Google Authenticator (PAM), UFW, journalctl

Lab 26 — Secrets Management with HashiCorp Vault · Slide 406

Goal: Run Vault to store static secrets, mint auto-expiring dynamic DB credentials and audit every access.

Key concepts:

- Never hard-code secrets; reference them from a secrets manager (Vault KV v2)
- Secret versioning for audit and rollback
- Dynamic, short-lived DB credentials with lease/TTL shrink the blast radius
- Audit logging of every secret access; cloud equivalents (Secrets Manager, Key Vault)

Tools: HashiCorp Vault, Docker, PostgreSQL, curl, jq

Lab 27 — Web Application Firewall with ModSecurity · Slide 407

Goal: Deploy Nginx + ModSecurity + the OWASP Core Rule Set and watch it block SQLi, XSS and path-traversal, then tune false positives.

Key concepts:

- WAFs inspect HTTP semantics (query strings, bodies, headers) — not just IP/port
- OWASP CRS catches the OWASP Top 10 out of the box (SQLi, XSS, LFI)
- Anomaly scoring with a block threshold and paranoia levels
- False-positive tuning done test → staging → prod; ACL vs WAF vs Security Group

Tools: Docker (owasp/modsecurity-crs), Nginx, OWASP CRS, curl

Lab 28 — Detecting Suspicious Activity with Falco · Slide 408

Goal: Run Falco and trigger runtime detections that map to CV0-004 attack categories, then route alerts to Prometheus / SIEM.

Key concepts:

- Runtime security uses kernel signals (eBPF) to spot bad behaviour
- Common detections: shell-in-container, sensitive-file reads, odd outbound connections
- Detections map to CV0-004 attack categories (privesc, cryptojacking, metadata abuse)
- Baseline-deviation alerting; events flow into Prometheus / SIEM

Tools: Falco (eBPF), Docker, falcosidekick, journalctl

Domain 5 — DevOps Fundamentals (10%) — Deck: divider slide 409; Slides 477–480

Source control and branching, CI/CD pipelines, web-service APIs (REST / GraphQL) and container orchestration with Kubernetes.

Lab 29 — Git Source Control & Branching · Slide 477

Goal: Exercise every CV0-004 source-control verb — commit, push, branch, merge, PR review, conflict resolution — against a self-hosted Gitea server.

Key concepts:

- Core Git workflow: commit → push → branch → PR → merge
- Feature branches and pull requests (the code-review sub-objective)
- Merge-conflict resolution as a normal part of the workflow
- Branch protection: require PR + approval, require CI green, block force-push

Tools: git, Gitea (self-hosted), curl, jq

Lab 30 — CI/CD Pipeline with GitHub Actions (act) · Slide 478

Goal: Build and run a local test → build → scan → deploy CI/CD pipeline with act, mapping each stage to CV0-004 CI/CD concepts.

Key concepts:

- A pipeline is YAML + jobs + dependencies (needs:) forming a DAG
- The canonical flow: test → build → scan → deploy
- Artifacts and packaging (container image + Dockerfile)
- Running Actions locally with act to iterate without pushing

Tools: act (nektos/act), Docker, git, pytest, Trivy

Lab 31 — REST & GraphQL APIs · Slide 479

Goal: Call a public REST API, host a local GraphQL server, stream over WebSockets and preview pub/sub event-driven messaging.

Key concepts:

- REST is stateless, uses HTTP verbs, one resource per URL, described by OpenAPI
- GraphQL: a single endpoint where the client picks exactly which fields to return
- Comparison of styles: REST vs SOAP vs GraphQL vs gRPC
- WebSockets for real-time streams; pub/sub as the base of event-driven architecture

Tools: curl, jq, GraphQL Yoga, websocat, redis-cli

Lab 32 — Container Orchestration with Kubernetes (k3s) · Slide 480

Goal: Install k3s and deploy, expose, scale, roll out/rollback, add persistence, self-healing and RBAC on a real Kubernetes cluster.

Key concepts:

- k3s is a minimal single-binary Kubernetes cluster installable in one command
- Deployments manage replica state; Services (NodePort) expose pods
- Horizontal scaling, rolling updates, rollout history and rollback
- Self-healing via liveness probes; PVCs for persistence; RBAC for authorization

Tools: k3s, kubectl, YAML manifests, curl

Domain 6 — Troubleshooting (12%) — Deck: divider slide 481; Slides 550–553

Methodically diagnosing and fixing deployment, network, security and container / resource issues using a repeatable triage workflow.

Lab 33 — Troubleshoot Deployment Issues · Slide 550

Goal: Reproduce and fix each CV0-004 6.1 deployment failure mode locally — resources, permissions, oversubscription, sizing, deprecation, quotas, regions.

Key concepts:

- Resource allocation / sizing failures cause OOM kills — size to peak load
- Permission misconfiguration fixed by mounting writable tmpfs/volumes
- Outdated/EoL definitions and deprecation are deployment risks — pin supported tags
- API throttling returns HTTP 429 — fix with quota increase, backoff, batching

Tools: Docker, curl, jq, region matrices

Lab 34 — Troubleshoot Cloud Network Issues · Slide 551

Goal: Reproduce and resolve CV0-004 6.2 network failures using an L2→L7 diagnostic ladder (DHCP, DNS, NTP, NAT, HTTP codes, routing, IP overlap).

Key concepts:

- DNS and NTP break 'everything else' when they fail
- NAT (MASQUERADE + ip_forward) enables outbound from private subnets
- HTTP status codes localise the failure layer (4xx client, 5xx server, 429 rate-limit)
- IP overlap needs NAT/re-IP; DHCP scope exhaustion needs a bigger subnet

Tools: dig/nslookup, ip, iptables, mtr, chrony, tcpdump

Lab 35 — Troubleshoot TLS, Cipher & Auth Issues · Slide 552

Goal: Reproduce and fix CV0-004 6.3 security failures from the CLI — deprecated ciphers, privesc, unauthorized access, leaked credentials, vulnerabilities.

Key concepts:

- Disable deprecated TLS (SSLv3/TLS 1.0/1.1); require TLS 1.2+ with AEAD ciphers
- Detect privilege escalation via auditd file watches and SUID hunting
- Detect brute force in SSH logs (fail2ban); find leaked credentials with gitleaks
- TLS handshake errors map to specific root causes (missing CA, cipher mismatch, expiry)

Tools: openssl, nmap, auditd, fail2ban, gitleaks, Trivy

Lab 36 — Troubleshoot Container & Resource Limits · Slide 553

Goal: Combine the Lab 33–35 methods to triage real container failures with a repeatable state → logs → stats → mounts → network workflow.

Key concepts:

- CrashLoopBackOff = process exits immediately; fix the entrypoint so it stays up
- OOMKilled is the smoking gun (OOMKilled=true); raise the limit or fix the leak
- Image-pull failures come from wrong names or missing registry auth
- The daily five: OOM, CrashLoop, ImagePull, DNS, read-only-fs; triage in a fixed order

Tools: docker (inspect/stats/logs), a triage.sh script, k9s/ctop

Resources Required

- A laptop / PC with a modern web browser and internet access.
- Killercoda Ubuntu Playground (free, browser-based) — the Linux labs:
<https://killercoda.com/playgrounds/scenario/ubuntu>
- Killercoda Kubernetes Playground (free, browser-based) — the Kubernetes labs (Lab 32), which need a real cluster:
<https://killercoda.com/playgrounds/scenario/kubernetes>
- Docker Desktop (free download, optional) — to run the container labs (Labs 6, 12, 36) locally instead of in the browser: <https://www.docker.com/products/docker-desktop/>
- Course repository (labs source and ready-made lab files):
<https://github.com/tertiarycourses/TGS-2024049214-CompTIA-Certified-Cloud-Training>
- Learner Guide and slide deck (download from the LMS: <https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/>).
- No cloud account or credit card is required. The browser playgrounds need no local installation; Docker Desktop is an optional local install for three labs.

Assessment

Assessment is held in the final **2 hours (4:30–6:30 PM on Day 2)** and comprises:

- **Written Assessment (WA)** — 1 hour, open-ended short-answer knowledge questions drawn from the course slides / modules.
- **Practical Performance (PP)** — 1 hour, activity-based tasks the learner performed in the labs (mapped to the learning outcomes).

Assessment flow: (1) TRAQOM — scan the QR code on the LMS and complete the survey; (2) Assessment Digital Attendance; (3) Assessment (WA + PP); (4) Submit answers on the LMS; (5) Sign the Assessment Summary Record.

Courseware and the assessment are on the LMS: <https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/>

Criteria for funding: learners must attend at least 75% of the course and be assessed as **Competent (C)** in both the Written Assessment and the Practical Performance.